

BenQ M550G

Only a budgeteer's option

The BenQ M550G GSM dual-band sports a champagne-coloured front facia, with a black rear panel. Chrome strips on the sides make it look sleek, but compromise on grip. The build quality is bad—it squeaks when you press it hard.

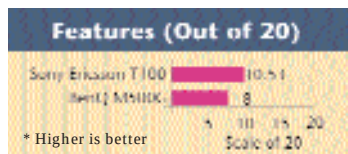
One feature that sets it apart is the inverted black LCD display—white text on a black background, with a choice of a blue, purple, or orange backlight. Though the purple looked gaudy, it was still the best backlight for the phone.

The buttons are placed tightly, making this phone a message junkies nightmare. The four-way navigation button is sure to give you dead-clicks. You can assign different icons for home, office, fax, etc., for your phonebook entries. The



phone comes with a charger, hands-free headset and a CD.

The M550G has voice clarity comparable to a Sony Ericsson T100. We couldn't check Internet connectivity, as there was no data cable provided. At Rs 5,750, the M550G is quite cheap for a phone that has GPRS and a bundled headset, but it loses on aesthetics and build-quality. Only if you're on a shoe string budget, and want a GPRS enabled phone, should you consider this an option.



SPECIFICATIONS

Dual-band; WAP 1.2.1; GPRS; 500 phone book memory; 79 gms; inverted black LCD; hands-free kit

BenQ M550G		B
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Build Quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	

Tech Com Keyboard

Keep off!

This keyboard is a vanilla keyboard with some extra multimedia keys thrown around for an upmarket feel. The keyboard sports a silver body, studded with black keys with white inscriptions. The first thing you notice is the extra buttons along the top edge, which allow you to control



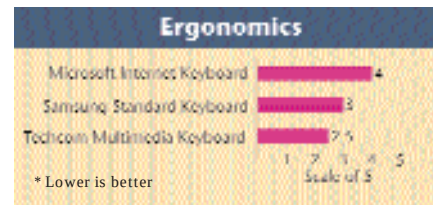
various features. They allow you to open the calculator, My Computer, increase or decrease the volume, open Media Player and play your favourite movies, or even open your e-mail client or browser. There is a 'Sleep' button to instantly put your computer into standby mode. The installation process is easy, with no issues at all, and the software is easy to configure.

On the ergonomics front, the keyboard isn't really spec-

tacular. The quality of keys in terms of tactile feel is very important, and though the keys afford touch typing, they are a bit tacky, and tend to get stuck with fast typing. Similarly, the multimedia buttons are of thick rubber, and using them is definitely not comfortable. They also totally lack finesse.

Priced at Rs 425, the keyboard is not expensive for the features that are on offer, but

Price: Rs 425
Contact: Shree Sagarmatha Distributors Pvt Ltd
Phone: 011-26428541
Fax: 011-26428540
E-mail: sagarmatha_dlh@bol.net.in



it fails where it matters the most. Despite its low price tag, we don't recommend it.

SPECIFICATIONS

PS/2 interface; 14 extra multimedia keys; three application buttons

Tech Com Keyboard		B
Ergonomics	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	

HandsPrint A6 Pocket Printer

A handy printer

The HandsPrint A6 pocket printer targeted at laptop and PDA users. It's light and comes with a velvet carry bag.

The A6 Pocket Printer is based on thermal printing technology, and prints on A6 sized papers at a maximum resolution of 400 dpi. However, you always need to use thermal paper to print. Connectivity to laptops and PDAs is provided through the serial port and infra-red. It requires four AA batteries for standalone printing, and also comes with a 230 V AC adaptor.

We printed a regular Word document from a PC, and it gave fairly good results. The smallest fonts were legible, and there weren't any smudges, but the print speed was somewhat slow. We then tested it on PDAs from different manufacturers. On PDAs



with the Palm OS, even after installing the proper drivers, the Pocket Printer refused to print, for no apparent reason.

This product has a price tag of Rs 5,000, a bit too high for the functionality it provides. It's unique in that it's portable, and it does its job perfectly well. It would be a wonderful companion for PDA users, once compatibility issues are smoothed out.

SPECIFICATIONS

Thermal printing technology, 400 dpi maximum resolution, A6 format printing, four AA batteries in standalone mode, A/C adaptor provided

Price: Rs 4,999
Contact: Pushpam Infotech Corporation
Phone: 9520-4215162
Fax: 9520-4211279
E-mail: sachin@pushpam.com
Web site: www.pushpam.com

HandsPrint A6 Pocket Printer		B-
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Build Quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	